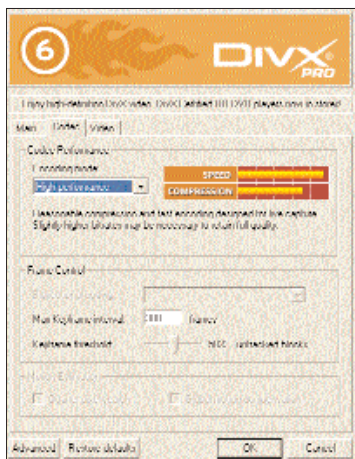


Unconstrained. When you choose one of the above profiles, it is virtually guaranteed that the encoded DivX file will be playable on any standalone DivX-certified player. Click on Settings. You can select a bitrate of your choice. A higher bitrate means a larger file size and better quality, while a lower bitrate means a smaller file size and lower image quality.

In the Codec tab, you can set the Encoding mode. The default setting is a good trade-off between quality and compression, but if you wish to control the file size, you can state your own mode such as High Performance, Better Quality, etc. Click on OK and then on Save to start the video demultiplexing

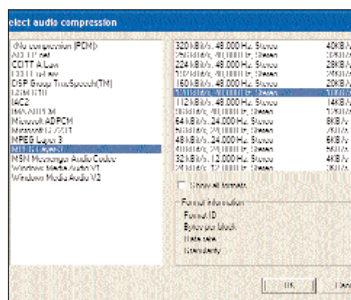


Choose the encoding mode in DivX

process. This will take some time depending on the speed of your computer. At the end of this process, you'll have an AVI file and a WAV file.

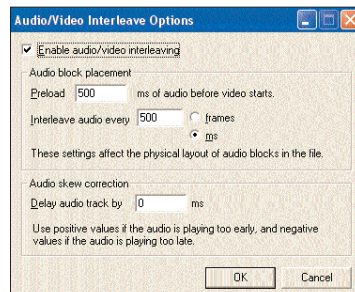
C) We now get to the creation of the DivX file—putting together the video (AVI) and audio (WAV) files that were created in the previous step. Launch VirtualDub. Under **File > Open**, browse to the folder where the AVI and the WAV files are stored. Select the AVI file and click Open.

D) Click on the Audio menu and click "Full Processing Mode". Click again on the Audio menu and select "WAV Audio". You will be prompted to open a WAV file. Select the WAV file you created earlier and click Open. Click on the Audio menu and then on Compression. Select "MPEG Layer-3" from the left pane and then select "128 kBit/s, 48,000 Hz, Stereo" in the right pane. Click OK.

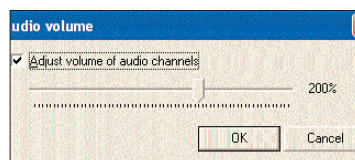


Select audio compression format

E) Select Interleaving from the Audio menu. Then, select the "ms" radio button and input "500" into the "Interleave audio every" dialog box. Click OK. Again, in the Audio menu, select Volume. Check the box and move the slider to 200 per cent. Click OK.



Set Interleave audio every 500 ms in VirtualDub



Set the Volume to 200% in VirtualDub

F) From the Video menu, select Direct Stream Copy.

G) Go to **File > Save as**. Enter a file name of your choice at a location of your choice, and click OK. This, again, will take some time, but not as much as the video encoding using DVD2AVI. After the process is complete, you'll have a DivX backup of your DVD movie.

H) All that's left now is to burn the DivX backup to CD or DVD using your DVD-Writer. Like we mentioned, you can make backups of several movies and cram them all into one DVD. How many depends, of course, on the quality settings you chose during the backup process. Remember, though, that distributing the DVD you create to friends is illegal! ■

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SimpleDivX

SimpleDivX is, as the name suggests, a really simple, free software to convert DVD movies to formats such as DivX. In this case, too, you need to first decrypt the DVD to your hard drive. The step-by-step, tabbed approach makes it easy for a novice to understand. It is highly customisable - for example, you can even set the location of the directory where the temporary files are stored. "DivX" in the name of the software is misleading - it can convert to MPEG-4 formats of any kind, such as XviD. This is one software worth trying!

